

Free and open source -- @ungatedbluemarble -- 2026 -- Runs inside Claude

CALIBRATED CANDIDATE

User Guide

Claude Free and Pro Plan Edition -- 2026

The structured job search system that runs inside Claude. Always free and open source. Works with any Claude account, free or paid. Built around the preparation that used to require a career coach, an insider network, or an expensive consultant.

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

Your job search has a system now.

Six weeks of silence. Applications going out. Nothing coming back. No idea what stage anything is at or why. That is the experience Calibrated Candidate was built to change.

Calibrated Candidate is a six-skill system that runs inside Claude. It is always free and open source. It builds your profile once and never asks again. It rewrites your resume, evaluates every job description you paste, preps you for specific interviews, runs mock sessions with graded feedback, tracks your pipeline, and negotiates your offer. All of it free. All of it on demand.

This guide tells you how to use it based on your Claude plan. Calibrated Candidate itself costs nothing. The only thing that changes between a free Claude account and a paid one is how many messages you get per session, which affects how much you can accomplish before taking a break.

YOUR CLAUDE PLAN

What changes between free and paid Claude accounts

Calibrated Candidate works identically on both. The difference is session capacity, not access.

Messages per 5-hour window	~9 to 10	~45
Access to Calibrated Candidate	Full access	Full access
All 6 skills available	Yes	Yes
Profile memory across sessions	Yes	Yes
Recommended session approach	One skill per session	Multiple skills per session
Priority access during peak hours	No	Yes
Full pipeline in one sitting	Pace across sessions	Yes

Your profile is built once and remembered across every session. You will never be asked the same questions twice regardless of which Claude plan you use.

USING CALIBRATED CANDIDATE ON CLAUDE FREE

One skill per session. One outcome at a time.

The Claude free plan gives you enough messages for one focused task per 5-hour window. That is not a constraint to work around. It is a workflow. Each session has a single clear purpose, a clear output, and a clear next step. Your profile carries forward so you never repeat yourself.

Your first session: build the profile

Do this once. Everything else in the system builds on it. It takes less than 10 minutes.

- 1 Open a new conversation in Claude**
Start fresh. Do not continue an old conversation for this step.
- 2 Tell Claude you want to start Calibrated Candidate**
Example: "I want to start Calibrated Candidate. Let's build my profile."
- 3 Answer the intake questions**
Claude asks about your background, strengths, target roles, and what you have tried. Answer completely. This is the only time you will be asked.
- 4 Confirm your profile**
Claude summarizes what it learned. Correct anything off. Once confirmed, your profile is saved to memory and recalled at the start of every future session.

Session by session after that

Follow this sequence or adjust it to your situation. If an interview is scheduled for tomorrow, jump to interview prep today. The system meets you where you are.

Session 2 Skill 2: Resume Writer

Upload your current resume. Claude rewrites it in professional language tailored to your target roles. A cover letter comes with it. Both are ready to send.

Tip: Save the documents before ending the session. Your profile persists but specific document text does not carry across sessions.

Session 3

Skill 3: Job Search Evaluator

Paste a job description. Claude reads it against your background and tells you whether it is worth applying, how to position yourself, and what to emphasize.

Tip: Do one job description per session on Claude free. Multiple JDs in one session will drain your message budget before you get useful analysis on each.

Session 4

Skill 4: Interview Prep

Tell Claude you have an interview scheduled. Give it the company name, role, and hiring manager if you have it. Claude builds a prep guide specific to that conversation.

Tip: One interview per session on Claude free. Run a separate session for each company you are preparing for.

Session 5

Skill 5: Mock Interviewer

Claude plays the interviewer. Every answer gets graded. You know exactly what to fix before the real conversation.

Tip: Treat it like the real interview. Claude asks one question at a time. Keep your answers focused and complete.

Session 6+

Skill 6: Pipeline Dashboard

Claude checks your pipeline status. If you have Gmail connected, it surfaces recruiter follow-ups automatically without you lifting a finger.

Tip: Use this any time something changes in your search. You do not need to wait for a fixed day.

Offer Stage

Skill 6: Offer Negotiation

When an offer comes in, tell Claude. It pulls compensation data for the role, level, and location. It explains applicable salary laws and builds your negotiation script.

Tip: Do not skip this. Most people leave money on the table by accepting the first number. This session takes less than 20 minutes.

USING CALIBRATED CANDIDATE ON CLAUDE PRO

More capacity. Same system. Same price.

Claude Pro gives you roughly five times more messages per window. Calibrated Candidate is still free. The skills and the system are identical. What changes is how much you can accomplish before pausing.

What Claude Pro unlocks in practice

- Resume rewrite and job description evaluation in the same session.
- Interview prep followed immediately by a mock interview without starting a new conversation.
- Multiple job descriptions evaluated back to back when actively filtering your pipeline.
- Pipeline check and offer negotiation prep in a single sitting when an offer comes in fast.
- A complete pipeline run from profile confirmation through mock interview in roughly 30 to 35 messages.

Claude Pro does not change what Calibrated Candidate does. It changes how much you can do before taking a break. Active job seekers running the system daily will feel the difference. Intermittent users may not need it.

Tips for all users

These apply regardless of which Claude plan you use.

- Start each session with a fresh conversation. Long chat history consumes tokens and reduces your available messages.
- Upload your resume once, save the output, and reference it in future sessions rather than re-uploading.
- Be specific in your first message. The more clearly you state what you need, the less back-and-forth is needed.
- If you hit your message limit mid-session, wait for the window to reset and continue in the same conversation. You do not lose progress.
- Start a new conversation for each new company target. Context from one company's prep can affect output quality for a different company.
- Run the mock interview toward the end of a session. It is the most message-intensive skill and works best after prep is complete.
- Save all document outputs before ending a session. Profile and pipeline state persist. Specific document text does not.
- You do not need Claude Pro to complete a successful job search. Claude free is sufficient when you pace it across sessions.

QUICK REFERENCE

All six skills at a glance

Skill 01 Profile Builder	Builds your shared profile used by every other skill.	Once at the start. Update when your situation changes.	Session 1	Session 1
Skill 02 Resume Writer	Rewrites your resume and produces a cover letter for your target roles.	When starting your search or shifting role type.	Session 2	Combine with Skill 03
Skill 03 Job Search Evaluator	Evaluates a job description against your background.	Every time a role catches your eye before applying.	One JD per session	Multiple JDs per session
Skill 04 Interview Prep	Researches the company. Builds a prep guide for your specific conversation.	When an interview is scheduled.	One interview per session	Combine with Skill 05
Skill 05 Mock Interviewer	Plays the interviewer. Grades every answer.	The night before an interview after prep is complete.	One mock per session	After Skill 04
Skill 06 Pipeline + Offer	Tracks applications, surfaces follow-ups, and builds your negotiation guide.	Ongoing. Any time something changes.	Anytime	Anytime

COMMON QUESTIONS

What you probably want to know

Does Calibrated Candidate cost anything?

No. Calibrated Candidate is free and open source. It always will be. The only cost involved is if you choose to upgrade your Claude account to Pro, which is Anthropic's paid plan. That is optional and affects session capacity, not access to Calibrated Candidate.

Do I need a paid Claude account?

No. Calibrated Candidate works on the Claude free plan. A paid Claude account gives you more messages per session, which means you can run more skills without pausing, but it is not required to complete a full job search.

What if Claude does not remember my profile?

Type: "Recall my Calibrated Candidate profile" at the start of the session. If memory has been cleared, run Skill 01 again. The intake takes less than 10 minutes and only needs to happen once.

Can I use Calibrated Candidate on mobile?

Yes. Claude is available on iOS and Android. All six skills work identically on mobile. Desktop is slightly more convenient for sessions involving document uploads, but mobile is fully functional.

What if I hit my message limit mid-session?

Wait for the 5-hour window to reset. Return to the same conversation and continue where you left off. You do not lose progress and Claude retains full context.

Can I share this with someone who is job searching?

Yes. That is the point. Share this guide and the link to Calibrated Candidate on GitHub. It is free for anyone with a Claude account. The more people who use it, the better it gets.

Calibrated Candidate is free and open source. It runs inside Claude and requires only a Claude account. No subscription. No payment. No sign-up beyond creating a Claude account.

Built by [@ungatedbluemarble](#)